

ODM-006 — Hypothesis

Status: Foundational

Authority: Methodology

Depends on:

- ODM-000 through ODM-005
 - OCS-000 through OCS-032
 - OAS-000 through OAS-031
 - OIS-000 through OIS-019
 - OGD-000 through OGD-023
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Purpose

This specification defines the constitutional role of the Hypothesis within the Organodynamics Discovery Methodology.

A Hypothesis is neither a belief nor a conclusion.

It is a disciplined commitment to investigate one proposed explanation before sufficient evidence exists to establish constitutional acceptance.

A Hypothesis guides inquiry.

It does not determine truth.

1. Objective

The objective of a Hypothesis is to provide a clearly articulated candidate explanation that can be examined through observation, reasoning, experimentation, comparison, and methodological review.

A Hypothesis SHALL preserve:

Transparency.

Testability.

Falsifiability.

Historical traceability.

Methodological humility.

2. Definition

A Hypothesis is an explicitly stated explanatory proposition selected for systematic investigation from among one or more Alternative Explanations.

The selection of a Hypothesis SHALL not imply constitutional preference beyond its role as the current object of investigation.

3. Hypothesis Record

Every Hypothesis SHALL preserve:

The originating Problem Frame.

The supporting Observations.

The contributing Patterns.

The Alternative Explanations considered.

Its explicit assumptions.

Its expected explanatory scope.

Known limitations.

Predicted consequences.

The Hypothesis record SHALL remain permanently accessible.

4. Testability

Every Hypothesis SHALL identify:

Observable consequences.

Potential supporting evidence.

Potential contradictory evidence.

Conditions under which the Hypothesis would require revision or rejection.

Testability SHALL remain explicit.

5. Relationship to Constitutional Knowledge

A Hypothesis SHALL remain external to the constitutional corpus until validated through the methodological processes defined by subsequent ODM specifications.

A Hypothesis MAY be strengthened.

It MAY be weakened.

It MAY be rejected.

Its constitutional status SHALL remain provisional.

6. Evolution

A Hypothesis MAY evolve as additional evidence becomes available.

Every revision SHALL preserve:

Previous formulations.

Reasons for revision.

Affected evidence.

Historical continuity.

Revision SHALL remain observable.

7. Verification

Verification SHALL demonstrate:

Internal coherence.

Evidence traceability.

Testability.

Methodological transparency.

Historical continuity.

Independent reproducibility.

Verification SHALL evaluate the quality of the hypothesis, not its eventual correctness.

8. Hypothesis Test

A Hypothesis satisfies this specification when independent researchers, given the same observations, problem frame, alternative explanations, and methodological record, consistently recognize it as a clearly defined, testable, and constitutionally legitimate object of scientific investigation.

Conformance

A Hypothesis conforms to this specification when it is transparently documented, explicitly testable, historically traceable, methodologically accountable, independently reviewable, and clearly distinguished from established constitutional knowledge.

Methodological Principle

Scientific progress does not begin when we become convinced.

It begins when we become willing to test our most promising explanation without confusing it with truth.

A Hypothesis is therefore an act of disciplined curiosity.

It is the temporary bridge between what has been observed

and what may eventually become constitutional understanding.

End of Specification ODM-006